

is generally required to take. This is the kind of storage infrastructure that can take a licking and keep on ticking. Bonus? The wired version allows the bulk of the dust and debris to float directly down to the floor, making it easy to vacuum up.

5. Keep everything off the floor

If you are following the tips above, this should be easy. Keeping everything off the floor via wired storage items and wall units makes routine pushbroom sweeping and power-vacuuming a breeze.

6. Bins

For durability, pick up the galvanized steel ones. They are rectangular, can be stored easily, and are very affordable. Some ways to use them? Storing jump ropes, baseball, gloves, soccer balls, and sports equipment in general. Gardening paraphernalia would also be a good candidate for bin storage.

7. Zones

One of the easiest ways to keep things from getting chaotic again is to keep all categories of items in their assigned zone. For example, all sports equipment, from volleyball nets to croquet to soccer balls should be stored in the

same general area. Ditto for lawn and garden items, as well as workshop items and general tools. Having a zone system keeps frustration levels low and success rates high during retrieval and return. Side perk? No more volleyball nets on your soldering table or hammers tossed in with the football pads.

8. Hang a neon Ping-Pong ball

If you are tired of having the car nick a work bench, use this marker to prevent a misjudgment in space. Pull the car in exactly where you want it parked. Then hang a bright-colored plastic Ping-Pong ball from a string attached to the ceiling. The trick is to hang the ball so it touches your windshield in a particular spot, like the center spot behind the rearview mirror or behind the inspection sticker. Your accidental paint dings from opening the vehicle door into the side of the lawn mower are a thing of the past.

9. Padded workstations

If you have one or two workstations in your garage where you need to stand for extended periods of time, consider giving your joints a break with padded floor tiles. You don't need to do the entire room, just a rectangular space large enough to step around on a bit. Your back will thank you.